Resilient Villages Zimbabwe

Anti-Fraud, Money Laundering, Corruption and Bribery Policy

January 2022

Document Property	Detail
Document Title	Anti-Fraud, Money Laundering, Corruption and Bribery Policy
Organization	Resilient Villages Zimbabwe (RVZ)
Document Version	Version 1.0
Document Status	Approved
Effective Date	January 2022
Target Audience	All Staff, Board Members, Vendors, Contractors, and Partner Organizations

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1. Executive Summary & Policy Objectives

Resilient Villages Zimbabwe (RVZ) is fully committed to upholding the highest standards of integrity, transparency, accountability, and ethical conduct across all its operations, programs, and administrative functions. Operating within the non-profit and community development sector, RVZ recognizes that fraud, money laundering, corruption, and bribery severely compromise organizational integrity, undermine public trust, divert critical resources away from vulnerable communities, and violate statutory and international regulatory legal frameworks.

This comprehensive policy establishes a zero-tolerance framework regarding any financial or administrative impropriety. The objectives of this policy are to:

- Protect the financial assets, physical operational resources, and ethical reputation of Resilient Villages Zimbabwe.
- Establish clear definitions, standards, and expectations regarding employee and partner conduct.
- Provide robust guidelines for the prevention, detection, reporting, and systematic investigation of suspected fraudulent activities, money laundering schemes, corruption, and bribery.
- Define internal roles and governance responsibilities to ensure structured accountability across all tiers of leadership and operations.
- Ensure full compliance with relevant Zimbabwean legal requirements, regulatory codes, international standards, and donor compliance guidelines.

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2. Scope & Corporate Governance Principles

2.1 Scope of Application

This policy applies universally to:

- All members of the Governing Board of Trustees of Resilient Villages Zimbabwe.
- All full-time, part-time, temporary, contract, and casual employees.
- Volunteers, interns, and seconded personnel across all operating sites and field projects.
- External consultants, vendors, contractors, sub-recipients, implementing partners, and third-party service providers operating under the authority or budget of RVZ.

This policy governs conduct in all operational sites, headquarters, field offices, digital networks, and third-party interactions associated with RVZ activities.

2.2 Core Governance Principles

Principle	Operational Mandate
Accountability	All organizational leaders, management personnel, and staff members are individually and collectively accountable for safeguarding organizational assets and ensuring compliance with established internal financial controls.
Transparency	Financial management, procurement, sub-granting, and operational procedures must remain fully verifiable, auditable, and accessible to authorized oversight bodies at all times.
Zero Tolerance	RVZ maintains a strict zero-tolerance posture toward fraud, corruption, bribery, and financial impropriety. Any confirmed breach will result in immediate disciplinary action, potential summary termination of employment or contracts, and referral to appropriate law enforcement authorities.
Whistleblower Protection	All individuals who report suspected misconduct in good faith are fully protected against retaliation, victimizations, unfavorable treatment, or adverse employment actions.

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3. Prohibited Conduct & Strategic Objectives

3.1 Prohibited Acts

Under this policy, all forms of dishonesty, financial manipulation, and corruption are strictly prohibited. Explicitly forbidden actions include, but are not limited to:

- **Embezzlement and Misappropriation:** Theft, unauthorized diversion, or misuse of organizational funds, property, intellectual property, or operational supplies.
- **Bribery and Kickbacks:** Offering, soliciting, promising, or accepting any financial gain, gift, or non-monetary favor in exchange for an operational, procurement, or employment advantage.
- **Falsification of Documentation:** Altering, forging, or fabricating invoices, receipts, timesheets, payroll entries, financial registers, or grant reporting documents.
- **Conflict of Interest Non-Disclosure:** Engaging in decision-making processes, procurement evaluations, or recruitment panels where a personal, financial, or familial relationship exists without formal disclosure.
- **Facilitation Payments:** Paying informal, unofficial funds to expedite or secure routine administrative actions by public officials or vendors.
- **Money Laundering Support:** Concealing, transferring, converting, or disguising funds derived from illegal activities or integrating untraceable financial capital into legitimate project budgets.

3.2 Strategic Objectives

To enforce these prohibitions, RVZ pursues five strategic anti-fraud pillars:

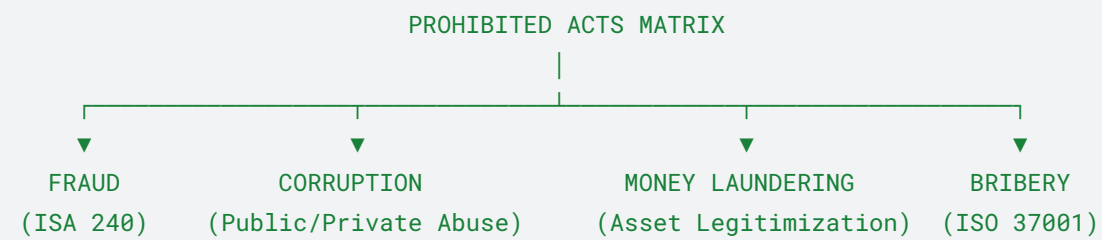
1. **Prevention:** Building resilient internal internal control systems, performing thorough third-party due diligence, and providing regular staff compliance training.
2. **Detection:** Establishing continuous monitoring mechanisms, statutory external audits, and robust internal audit schedules.
3. **Reporting:** Maintaining secure, confidential channels for reporting suspected violations without fear of reprisal.
4. **Response:** Conducting swift, professional, impartial, and evidence-based investigations into all credible allegations.
5. **Remediation:** Implementing corrective internal measures, prosecuting perpetrators, and enforcing financial recovery protocols.

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4. Detailed Definitions & Standards

To ensure clarity, this policy adopts regulatory alignment with international auditing criteria, specifically **ISA 240** (*The Auditor's Responsibilities Relating to Fraud in an Audit of Financial Statements*) and **ISO 37001** (*Anti-Bribery Management Systems*).

None



Fraud (ISA 240 Standard)

An intentional act by one or more individuals among management, those charged with governance, employees, or third parties, involving the use of deception to obtain an unjust or illegal advantage. Fraud encompasses:

- **Financial Statement Fraud:** Intentional misstatements, omissions, or misrepresentations of amounts or disclosures in financial statements to deceive users.
- **Asset Misappropriation:** Theft of an entity's assets, including skimming receipts, stealing physical inventory or intellectual property, causing an entity to pay for goods and services not received, or using an entity's assets for personal use.

Corruption

The abuse of entrusted power or official position for private gain, whether public or private. This includes extortion, nepotism, cronyism, influence peddling, and illicit enrichment at the expense of organizational programs or beneficiaries.

Money Laundering

The process by which proceeds from illegal activity, criminal acts, or corrupt arrangements are processed, converted, or transferred to disguise their illegal origin and make them appear as legitimate financial capital. It covers placement, layering, and integration phases.

Bribery (ISO 37001 Standard)

Offering, promising, giving, accepting, or soliciting an undue advantage of any value (financial or non-financial), directly or indirectly, and irrespective of location(s), in violation of applicable law, as

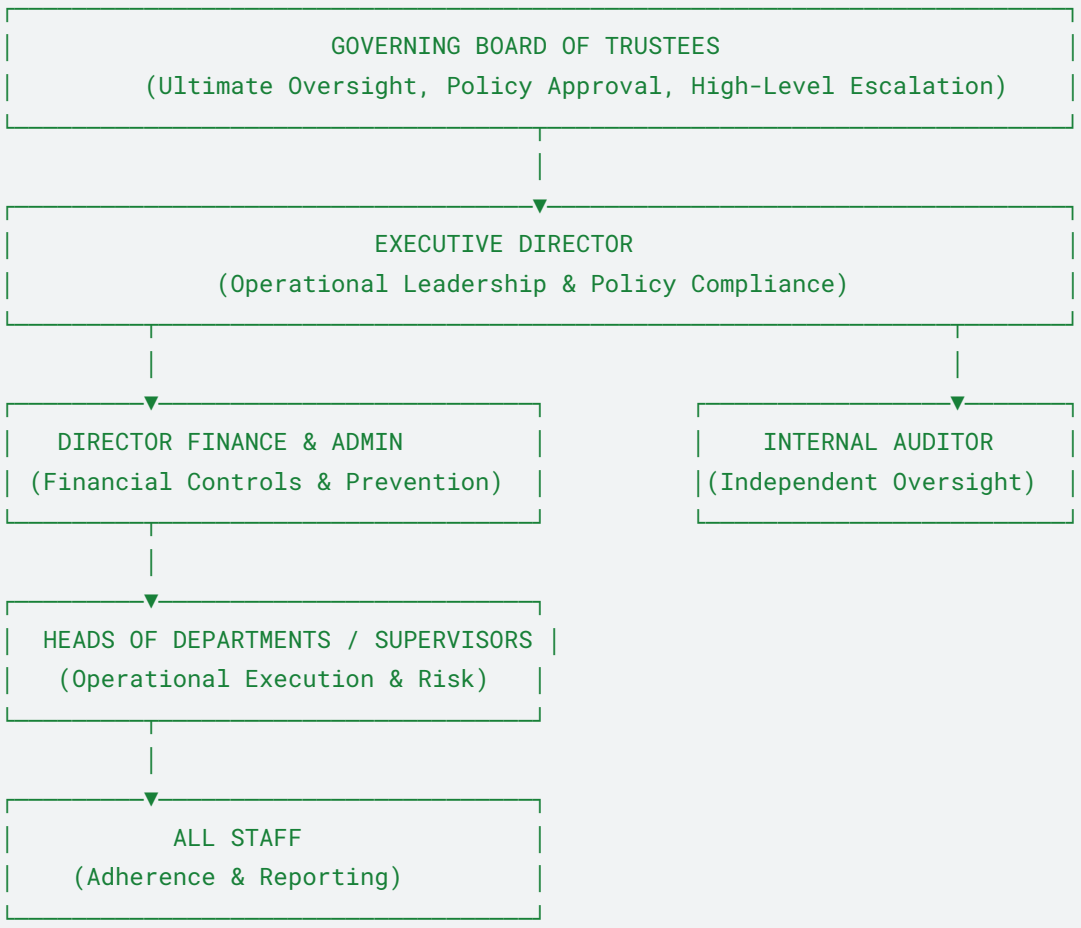
an inducement or reward for a person acting or refraining from acting in relation to the performance of that person's duties.

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5. Governance Roles & Responsibilities

Organizational governance requires clear distribution of oversight, execution, operational management, and independent verification responsibilities.

None



Governing Board of Trustees

- Serves as the ultimate authority for policy approval, institutional governance, and ethical direction.
- Maintains independent oversight of organizational financial health and risk management frameworks.

- Designates specialized Board Audit and Risk Committee members to review investigation reports involving senior management.

Executive Director (ED)

- Bears operational accountability for the implementation and enforcement of this policy across all units.
- Promotes an organizational culture of integrity, ethics, and strict zero-tolerance.
- Receives direct notifications of major fraud incidents and authorizes specialized internal or external investigations.

Director of Finance & Administration

- Designs, implements, and monitors robust internal financial control systems, segregation of duties, and authorization hierarchies.
- Ensures regular reconciliations, financial reviews, and procurement audits.
- Coordinates external audits and manages the financial documentation required for regulatory compliance.

Heads of Departments (HODs) & Supervisors

- Identify operational risk exposure within their respective functional units and field programs.
- Ensure all direct reports receive proper onboarding, training, and operational guidance on policy compliance.
- Immediately report any observed irregularities or received allegations through designated channels.

Internal Auditor

- Performs independent, periodic reviews of accounting registers, procurement files, and operational workflows.
- Conducts preliminary reviews of reported improprieties and advises management on risk mitigation strategies.
- Maintains the central Fraud Risk Register and tracks remediation progress.

All Staff Members

- Adhere strictly to institutional ethical guidelines, internal control procedures, and financial policies.
- Safeguard organization assets, resources, equipment, and records under their custody.
- Promptly report any reasonable suspicion of fraud, corruption, bribery, or money laundering.

6. Fraud Response Plan & Escalation Matrix

6.1 Fraud Escalation Matrix

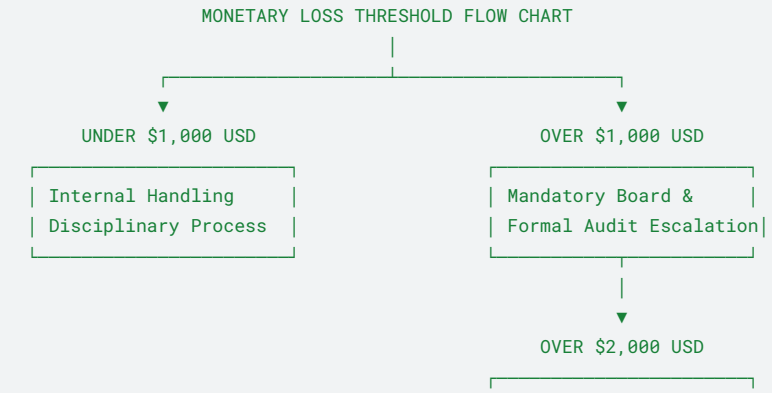
When suspected misconduct is identified, it must be reported through established lines of authority based on the level of the suspected party.

Suspected Party	Primary Notified Party	Alternate Contact	Primary Investigator
Staff Member / Officer	Direct Supervisor / HOD	Director Finance & Admin	Internal Auditor / Designate...
Supervisor / HOD	Director Finance & Admin	Executive Director	Internal Auditor / External E...
Director Finance & Admin	Executive Director	Board Audit Committee Chair	External Independent Inves...
Executive Director	Board Chairperson	Board Audit Committee Chair	External Independent Inves...
Board Member	Board Chairperson	Executive Director	Special Board Sub-Committ...

6.2 Monetary Threshold Reporting Rules

To ensure proportionate, structured, and compliant escalation, financial loss thresholds dictate mandatory action pathways:

None





Incident Involving Losses Under $1,000 USD

- **Reporting:** Reported internally to the Director of Finance & Administration and Executive Director within 24 hours of discovery.
- **Action:** Investigated by the Internal Auditor or an internally designated investigation team.
- **Resolution:** Handled via internal administrative and disciplinary frameworks, with corrective management actions applied to internal controls.

Incident Involving Losses Over $1,000 USD

- **Reporting:** Escalated to the Governing Board (via Audit and Risk Committee) within 48 hours.
- **Action:** Requires formal audit engagement and potential independent external investigation.
- **Resolution:** Documented formal response plan, mandatory employment review, and legal assessment for asset recovery.

Incident Involving Losses Over $2,000 USD (Donor & Statutory Trigger)

- **Reporting:** Immediate mandatory escalation to the full Governing Board of Trustees within 24 hours.
- **Donor Notification:** Mandatory written notification submitted to relevant funding partners and grant agencies within contractual notification deadlines (not to exceed 5 business days).
- **Legal Escalation:** Mandatory reporting to local law enforcement agencies (e.g., Zimbabwe Republic Police - Commercial Crimes Division) and national regulatory frameworks.

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7. Investigation Protocols & Post-Investigation Actions

7.1 Investigation Protocols

All reports of fraudulent conduct, bribery, corruption, or money laundering will be evaluated and investigated promptly, impartially, and thoroughly.

1. **Confidentiality:** The identity of the reporter and all investigative details will be kept strictly confidential, shared only on a clear need-to-know basis.
2. **Evidence Preservation:** Upon notification, the investigation team will immediately secure all physical documents, digital records, storage drives, communications, and system logs relevant to the case.
3. **Right to Fair Hearing:** Investigations will adhere to principles of natural justice. Suspected individuals will be provided an opportunity to respond to specific allegations within formal disciplinary settings.
4. **Independent Expertise:** RVZ reserves the right to engage specialized external forensic accountants, legal counsel, or cyber-investigators where required.

7.2 Post-Investigation Actions & Remediation

Following the completion of an investigation and presentation of a formal Audit & Investigation Report, RVZ leadership will enforce the following protocols:

- **Disciplinary Sanctions:** Employees found in breach of this policy will face disciplinary proceedings, which may result in summary dismissal for gross misconduct, termination of contract, and loss of professional clearance.
- **Civil Proceedings & Financial Recovery:** RVZ will initiate legal proceedings to recover stolen assets, misused grant funds, or damaged physical property.
- **Law Enforcement Referral:** Confirmed criminal acts will be referred to relevant authorities for criminal prosecution.
- **Internal Control Review & Impact Assessment:** Within 30 days of an investigation concluding, the Director of Finance & Administration, alongside the Internal Auditor, must complete a root-cause impact assessment to identify policy gaps and implement enhanced control mechanisms.

7.3 Policy Review Cycle

This policy document shall be formally reviewed by the Governing Board of Trustees every **two (2) years**, or immediately following significant legislative changes or major operational incidents, to ensure its continued effectiveness and alignment with global best practices.

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8. Formal Approval & Authorization

This Anti-Fraud, Money Laundering, Corruption and Bribery Policy has been reviewed, formally approved, and authorized for immediate implementation by the Governing Board of Trustees and Executive Leadership of Resilient Villages Zimbabwe.

Authorization	Signature & Details
Board Chairperson	Signature: _____**Sr Stellar Gaihai Khumalo**Chairperson, Governing Board of Trustees
Executive Director	Signature: _____**Jerald Ndungwani**Executive Director

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9. Employee & Associate Acknowledgement Form

All current employees, board members, third-party contractors, and project partners must complete, sign, and return this acknowledgement form to the Human Resources and Administration Department within fourteen (14) days of onboarding or policy publication.

I confirm that I have received, read, and fully understood the **Resilient Villages Zimbabwe Anti-Fraud, Money Laundering, Corruption and Bribery Policy**.

I agree to comply with all provisions, standards, guidelines, and reporting obligations set forth within this document. I understand that any violation of this policy may lead to formal disciplinary action, employment or contract termination, civil litigation, and criminal prosecution.

Field	Details
Full Name	Person
Job Title / Role	_____
Department / Organization	_____
Work Location / Office	Place
Signature	_____
Date	Date